



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Evergreen Classical School
School Website: <https://evergreenclassicalschool.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Evergreen Classical School TX 77380 presents a clearly classical, Christian, and collaborative model. Public materials from the site consistently foreground a Christian, Biblical, and Trivium-based framework, with explicit emphasis on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, and a commitment to formation of character and virtue. The school openly describes its aim as Biblically anchored, classical, and community-centered, with a strong parental partnership component and a blended (collaborative) pedagogy. Evidence throughout the materials shows explicit reference to the Triune God, Scripture, and worship-oriented language, alongside classical liberal arts content (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and a "Great Conversation" with Great Books, and a call to virtue and wisdom.

Overall classification across the six classical criteria leans CLASSICAL, with a few category-specific nuances that temper full certainty in Pedagogy (category 4). The strongest alignments are in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The Pedagogy category shows substantial classical elements (including contemplative/restful aspects and memory-based practice) but is slightly weaker on explicit Socratic/seminar-based high-school pedagogy in public materials, which places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for that single category. The aggregate assessment remains predominantly CLASSICAL.

- Strong religious/metaphysical grounding: Christian/Biblical framing; Triune God; Scripture and worship language.
- Clear teleology toward virtue, wisdom, and formation (not merely information).
- Curriculum built around Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis.
- Pedagogy emphasizes both contemplative/restful aspects (Scholé) and memory-based recitation, with higher-grade opportunities for dialogue/debate; explicit Socratic/seminar language is less prominent in the public-facing materials, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating in Pedagogy.
- Faculty are presented as living curriculum and partner with families; visible faculty profiles and a Board of Directors indicate a strong community framework.
- Parents as co-teachers and partners are front-and-center; clear emphasis on family partnership and collaboration with church communities.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases): provide more explicit, public-facing articulation of Socratic seminar practices in upper grades, broaden explicit "Great Books" integration across core subjects, and foreground Scholé as a daily, stated pedagogy across all grades (not only in lower-grade indications).

- Abstracted overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Citations drawing on the school's public materials and the classical-rubric references are embedded throughout this report. See specific category evidences from items such as Evergreen's mission and public descriptions of Christian/Classical/Collaborative framing, Trivium content, and Great Books language.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school markets itself as "Christian, distinguishably Classical, and collaboratively" and emphasizes Biblically anchored aims (e.g., recognizing, desiring, and proclaiming the Triune God). The mission and vision statements explicitly reference God, Scripture, and Biblical training. - Language centers on Christ, God, and worship-like framing (e.g., "Our desire is to create an environment in which the Holy Spirit invites our students to experience the fullness of Christ," and "worshiping the Trinity as image bearers"). This is reinforced in the firecrawl materials. - The Great Conversation / Great Books and the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) are presented as core to the religiously anchored Classical model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Christian, Biblical, Triune God, Christ, Scripture, worship, God, Holy Spirit, Trinity, Great Conversation, Great Books, Trivium. - Negative indicators: None of the explicit secular/anti-religious indicators appear; no conflict with transcendental realism is stated negatively in public materials.

Why this rating - The public-facing content strongly situates the school within a theologically grounded classical frame and uses liturgical/community language (worship, Trinity, Scripture). This aligns with the Transcendental moral realism and Grounded in Theology criteria from the classical rubric. The absence of secular or non-theological framing supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school frames its goal as formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely preparation for work. The mission states formation to recognize, desire, and proclaim Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, with a clear emphasis on character and virtue. - The purpose emphasizes soul formation and the classical triad (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) as real and knowable, with emphasis on virtue and moral imagination. This is echoed in program overviews and the Primer/Academics language. - The Great Conversation, the Trivium, and a call to virtue align with the goal of forming well-rounded human beings (not solely job-ready).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: virtue, wisdom, formation, Truth, Goodness, Beauty, soul formation, character, moral imagination, lifelong learners, Great Conversation. - Negative indicators: None evident in public materials; no emphasis on technical metrics or job-prep language.

Why this rating - The public materials emphasize virtue formation, wisdom formation, and the reality of Truth/Beauty, consistent with CLASSICAL. The absence of a primary job-focused framing reinforces formation as the overarching goal.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The curriculum centers on the liberal arts of grammar, logic, and rhetoric (the Trivium). It explicitly references the Trivium and Great Books as part of the curriculum. - History is integrated across the curriculum with emphasis on Great Books and Great Conversation, rather than treating history as mere social studies. - There is explicit mention of the liberal arts in preparatory sections (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and a description of the classical curriculum including the Great Books framework. - Primer/Logic/Primer School detail emphasize wonder and development within the classical framework, with a focus on formation through the liberal arts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal arts, history across the curriculum, wonder, formation through classical canon. - Negative indicators: None evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly classical and canonical (Trivium; Great Books; history within the curriculum; emphasis on wonder and formation). This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Lower grades emphasize contemplative, restful learning and memory-building through singing/chanting (Scholé-like practices) and memorization. This is visible in lower-grade descriptions and organizational materials describing Primer instruction and collaborative activities. - Upper grades are described as engaging in Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates and using rhetoric in instruction; the classical model anticipates these discussions; however, explicit public-facing statements about full Socratic-method implementation across all upper grades are not consistently visible in the provided public content. Still, the pathway to debate and rhetoric is indicated in the model. - The materials emphasize a blend of contemplative and rigorous elements, consistent with a classical pedagogy that uses both memory-based practice and higher-order discussion. The “Scholé” and memory-oriented approach is explicitly stated in public materials; upper-grade Socratic dialogs/seminars appear as a component of the pedagogy, though not always described in every page.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Scholé (restful learning), singing/chanting/memorization, formation through imitation and practice, Socratic dialogue/dialectic (as a potential practice in high school), guided inquiry. - Negative indicators: Explicit, public-facing, universal implementation of Socratic seminars across all grades is not consistently shown in the available public content. The presence of a strong contemplative/memory-based pedagogy without consistent explicit public statements of full Socratic method reduces the absolutism of “Socratic” pedagogy in all grades.

Why this rating - The school exhibits substantial classical pedagogy elements (restful learning, memorization/chanting, formation through imitation) and indicates high-level Socratic/seminar practices for upper levels, but the public materials do not always present a uniform, fully explicit, grade-wide Socratic approach. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL in Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue, skill, and knowledge; the living curriculum concept is present in the public materials, and faculty/staff profiles exist (e.g., individual faculty bios). The school emphasizes partnerships with faculty and parents as part of the educational approach. - The school presents a board of directors and named faculty (e.g., Cindy Medema, Carly Meservey, Robyn Bain) with bios and roles; this reflects a community-focused and mentorship-oriented faculty culture. - The “Faculty & Staff” and “Board of Directors” sections indicate a formal living-curriculum model in which teachers are central to school culture and pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: living curriculum, model teachers and mentors, teacher as central to school culture, faculty profiles, collaboration with parents. - Negative indicators: No explicit negative phrases about faculty; no contrasting language found in public materials.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently position faculty as core to the school’s classical mission and the living curriculum, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Evergreen emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers in educating their children and as part of a collaborative model; there are explicit references to parent collaboration and shared mission. The site highlights parental involvement, co-teaching roles, and community engagement (including church connections and informational meetings). - The materials indicate involvement of families in the educational endeavor, the need for parents to participate and be informed (admissions process and informational meetings), and an emphasis on parent formation and engagement (including book studies and gatherings). - The school invites parent participation in co-teaching and in governance (Board composition includes families; the faculty pages reflect a family-inclusive environment).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with families, parent co-teaching, family involvement, informational meetings, book studies, gatherings, parent formation, school as extension of family life. - Negative indicators: None evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - There is robust, explicit emphasis on parents as co-educators and on family engagement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for community/parent involvement. The materials consistently present a family-centric, church-linked community model.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Socratic/seminal pedagogy explicit for all grades: Publish a clear, public framework showing how Socratic dialogue and seminars are implemented across middle and upper grades, with sample rubrics and outcomes, to strengthen the Pedagogy category to CLASSICAL.
- Publicly foreground Scholé as a daily, across-the-board practice: While there are hints of contemplative/memory work, a formal, universal statement across all grades about restful learning (Scholé) would strengthen Element 4.
- Expand Great Books integration across core subjects: Emphasize the Great Books as a recurring, grade-spanning requirement beyond the upper grades to strengthen Curriculum and its articulation in the Great Conversation across content areas.
- Increase transparent articulation of “living curriculum” in faculty communications: Publish more explicit language about how faculty embody and enact the living curriculum in day-to-day teaching across grade levels, increasing perceived alignment with the Faculty rubric.
- Document measurable virtue/character formation outcomes: Add public metrics or narrative evidence of character formation and virtue development (to align with the Formation of Affections and Cultivation of Wisdom/ Virtue indicators) and connect to assessment practices.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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